There are many possible ways to implement this service, and we won't delve into the details here. But along the way, you may discover other services or components that you need, which in turn you can mock out and then implement. Once there are no more mocked-out classes to implement, the acceptance criteria will run correctly, and you'll have finished the feature.

2.4.5 Tests as living documentation

Once a feature has been implemented, you should be able to run your tests and see passing acceptance criteria among the pending ones (see figure 2.9). When you're applying practices like BDD, this result does more than simply tell you that your application satisfies the business requirements. A passing acceptance test is also a concrete measure of progress. An implemented test either passes or fails. Ideally, if all of the acceptance criteria for a feature have been automated and run successfully, you can say that this feature is finished and ready for production.

More than just evaluating the quality of your application, the state of the tests gives a clear indication of where it's at in the development progress. The proportion of passing tests compared to the total number of specified acceptance criteria gives a

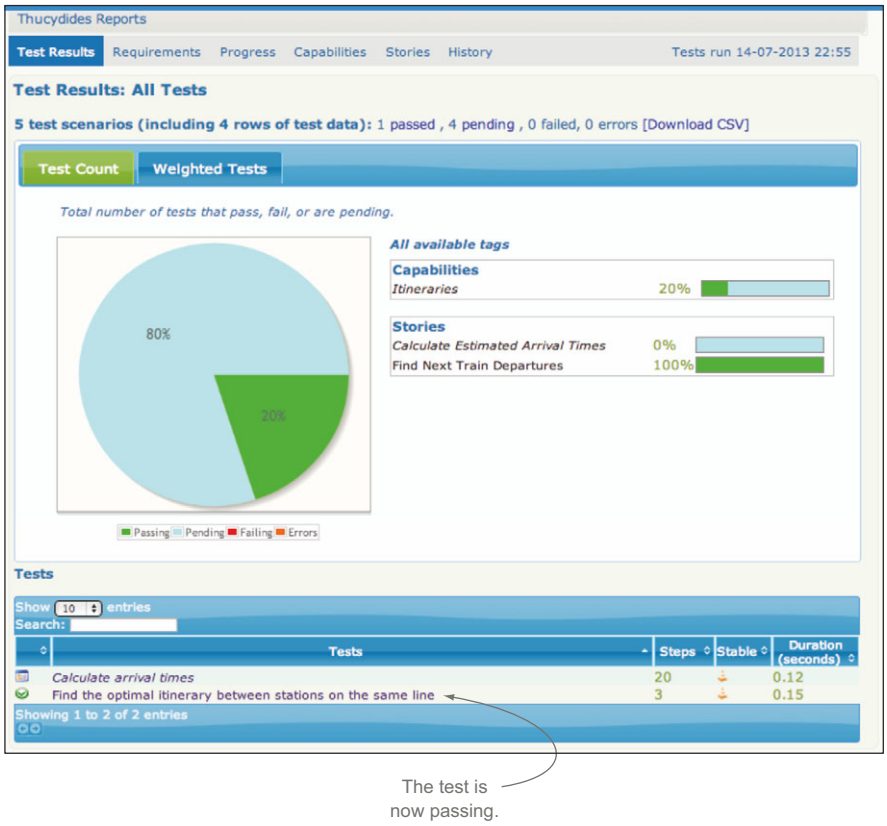


Figure 2.9 The passing test should now appear in the test reports